CEFIXIME

Once or twice daily

Cross-allergy

CHEMICAL NAME (6R,7R)-7-[[(2Z)-2-(2-amino-1,3-thiazol-4-yl)-2-(carboxymethoxyimino)acetyl]amino]-3-ethenyl-8-oxo-5-thia-1-azabicyclo[4.2.0]oct-2-ene-2-carboxylic acid

CLASS Third-generation cephalosporin (oral)

TRADE NAMES Suprax · Ximeprox · Cefix · Taxim-O

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Urinary tract infections (uncomplicated and step-down).
- Typhoid fever (enteric fever); oral treatment.
- Otitis media, pharyngitis, acute exacerbation of bronchitis.
- Uncomplicated gonorrhoea (where guidelines permit).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** tablets, capsules or suspension, with or without food.
- Suspension: shake well; stable 14 days at room temperature.

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 400 mg once daily or 200 mg every 12 h.
- **Typhoid (adult):** 200–400 mg every 12 h for 10–14 days.
- **Children:** 8 mg/kg/day once daily or divided every 12 h.
- **CrCl ≥20:** normal dose; **<20:** max 200 mg once daily.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 2–6 h. Bioavailability 40–50%.
- Not significantly metabolised.
- Excreted in urine and bile. **t½:** 3–4 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits **cell-wall synthesis** → bactericidal.
- Good Gram-negative activity (*E. coli*, *Salmonella*, *H. influenzae*, *N. gonorrhoeae*); poor against *Staph. aureus*; no *Pseudomonas* cover.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Diarrhoea and loose stools (common), abdominal pain.
- Nausea, flatulence.
- Headache, rash.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Anaphylaxis.
- *C. difficile* colitis.
- SJS (rare); transient liver enzyme rise.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Cephalosporin hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** severe penicillin allergy, renal impairment, colitis history.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Warfarin:** ↑ INR.
- **Carbamazepine:** ↑ levels (reported).
- **Live typhoid vaccine:** inactivated.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Check allergy history.
- Monitor temperature curve in typhoid.
- Monitor stool frequency and hydration.
- Make sure completion of full course.
- Check renal function in elderly.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take at the same times each day.
- Finish the course, especially for typhoid.
- Report watery or bloody diarrhoea, rash.

KEY POINTS

- Oral 3rd-gen cephalosporin.
- Poor Staph cover; no Pseudomonas.
- UTI and typhoid; child 8 mg/kg/day.
- Diarrhoea common.

SOURCES CHECKED [132] Suprax 200mg Tablets (UK SmPC) [133] Cefixime, oral (US label) [134] Cefixime, oral (US label, REMEDYREPACK INC) *Full references p. 432–457*